# Competitor comparison: how train apps handle a cancelled waitlisted ticket

Owner: Rahul | Status: Draft v1 | Focus: the refund problem from PRD v1. Cells marked "not checked" or "not confirmed" are still open.

| | cnftkt (reference) | IRCTC | RailOne | MakeMyTrip |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Who it's for** | Train bookers, many of them students; also flights, buses, hotels | Official railway ticketing platform; also bus, flight and hotel booking | Railways' all-in-one app; reserved tickets are still offered through IRCTC | General travel booking: flights, hotels, trains |
| **Waitlisted ticket not confirmed: where does the refund go?** | Wallet or original source, picked at booking and locked | Original payment source, automatically (my observation) | Automatically, no option shown (my observation). A blog says original method or R-Wallet | Policy page says the card or bank account used at booking |
| **Is a refund choice shown at cancellation?** | No for waitlisted tickets (asked at booking). Yes for confirmed tickets the user cancels | No (my observation) | No (my observation) | Not confirmed |
| **Wallet** | Yes: instant and withdrawable | Not checked | R-Wallet exists. A news report says some users could not withdraw wallet money to a bank | Has MyWallet (older report: for flight refunds). Use for trains not confirmed |
| **Backup if a waitlisted ticket fails** | Alternate plan: refund plus 2x/3x/4x coupon | Not checked | Not checked | Not checked |
| **How I checked** | Own use for 2 to 3 years | Own use of the app | Own use of the app | Public policy pages, and my own knowledge of its wallet |

## Where my idea fits

1. In the apps I checked, IRCTC and RailOne send the refund back automatically and give the user no choice, based on my own use. MakeMyTrip's policy page also sends it to the original source, and whether it offers a wallet choice for trains is not confirmed.

2. cnftkt is the only one in this comparison that already offers an instant, withdrawable wallet for train refunds, but it asks at booking, about 30 days early, and locks the answer. So the gap is not that nobody offers a wallet. It is that nobody asks at the moment of cancellation, when the money is needed.

3. A news report about RailOne users who could not withdraw wallet money supports my belief that people fear locked wallet money, so the message "withdraw anytime" on the choice screen matters. This comparison covers 3 apps, mostly from my own use and public pages, so it needs a second look before I call the gap proven.

*Note: ixigo also runs a similar waitlist guarantee (refund plus wallet credit). It is not in this comparison, but it is worth checking next if you want a fourth app.*